14 Being brief and businesslike

A **Look at the differences in style between these two emails. Notice how version 2 uses the key words from version 1. The form and order of the words may be different.**

Version 1

Subject: My ideas following last Friday's meeting
In the attached Word document you'll find my thoughts about the marketing plan that we discussed in last Friday's meeting, and in particular my response to Jenny's points about needing a new type of packaging to appeal to a younger age group. I think she raised some important issues, and so I'm circulating my ideas on this to everyone involved. Please insert your comments in red in the attached document and email it back to me as soon as possible.

Version 2

Subject: Ideas for packaging
We need a new type of packaging – as we all agreed in the last meeting. My ideas are in the attached doc. Comments please asap.

Now read statements 1–4 and say whether they best describe version 1 or version 2 above.

1 The email is very direct, very brief, and typical of many business emails. *Version 1/2*
2 The email gives more context, and so might be better for people not in the meeting. *Version 1/2*
3 The action required by the reader is not 100% clear. More words might be better. *Version 1/2*
4 There may be too much in the email to write and read in a busy working day. *Version 1/2*

B **Rewrite the email below. The maximum length is 50 words, including the subject line. Some key words have been underlined to help you, but you may need to change their form and order.**

Subject: Confirmation of our meeting as discussed by phone
I'm writing regarding our phone call earlier this morning. It was a very useful discussion and I am much clearer now about your objectives. At the end of the call you suggested a time and place for our next meeting, namely the lobby of the Intercontinental Hotel in Bangkok at 2.00 pm on 7 February. You mentioned this time would be convenient for you because you will be staying at the hotel. I said I would email you to confirm the meeting. Well, for me the time and place is very good – I am free all afternoon. I look forward to seeing you there and I hope that in the evening you can be my guest for dinner at a restaurant in the neighbourhood of the hotel.

Subject: Confirmation of next meeting
I'm writing to inform you that the time and location of the next meeting are perfect for me. Also, I would like to invite you to dinner nearby after the meeting.

C **Cross out 20 words which are not necessary in this email.**

Many thanks for your email which I received yesterday. Tuesday at 10.30 is fine for me as my 9 am meeting will be finished by then. Can you send me the latest sales figures before the meeting? I look forward to seeing you there.

D **Underline the key words, then rewrite the email. The maximum length is 60 words, including the subject line.**

Subject: Info re market developments in the Baltic States

Many thanks for getting in touch last week and sending me all the information about market changes in the Baltic States. It was really useful, particularly the graphs about expected demand for consumer products over the next five years. I've forwarded your email to our representative in Estonia, Krista Kilvet. She has just taken over from Doris Kareva, who I think you met in Stuttgart. Would you be interested in giving a presentation at our Head Office on the whole economic and business background in the region? I'm sure the Board would be interested as we may be making some large investments there in the near future.

Subject: Presentation Invitation

Thank you for your information last time. Your insight about market change and the economy (economic is adjective and exonomy is noun) is incrediable.

Due to the Board's interest in this market and is considering making investments there, we would like to invite you to giving a presentatation at our Head Office.

E **Underline the key words, then rewrite the email. The maximum length is 60 words, including the subject line.**

Subject: Thank you for your help at the conference in Paris

Thank you so much for all your help during the conference on the future of the airline industry that I attended in Paris last week. Your help was really appreciated as I had never been to France before and everything was very new to me. The conference was really interesting. Of course, while I was there I also had the great pleasure to meet your French sales team. They are a wonderful group of people and I would like you to give my best regards to all of them. As you know, there are plans to bring some of the French staff over here to Dubai at the end of the year to see how we run the Dubai office. I look forward to seeing you then.

Subject: Appriciate your help at Paris

Thanks for your help at the conference last time. Also, it was a great pleasure to meet your sales team; they are a wonderful group of people. Anyway, there are plans to bring some of French staff over here to Dubai. Looking forward to seeing you then.

Note: it is fine to send a very brief, direct email in certain contexts. For example, writing to a colleague you see every day about a routine matter, or writing an email on a smartphone. In some other contexts a very brief, direct email might be seen as rude and unfriendly or might not be clear.